



A Marketing Mix

When planning a product launch or marketing campaign, you need to consider four key elements that together make up the “marketing mix”: the product or service itself, its price, how it is promoted, and where it is sold.

Using the mix

The success of your product or service—however brilliant or innovative—relies on sales. To achieve good sales, you need a well-targeted marketing approach, using a mix of four ingredients. The first is your product or service itself and what it offers the customer.

The next is the price structure, reflecting what your target market will accept. You must then decide how to promote your offering and where and how to distribute it. Each of these ingredients is a powerful tool you can use to persuade target customers that your product or service is what they want and need.

4Ps—business-oriented

The product, price, promotion, and place marketing mix is an approach that is business-led rather than customer-oriented.



PRODUCT

- › Will the **product design**, size, features, color, and packaging appeal to customers?
- › What **unique benefits** and solutions does the product offer?
- › How does it **compare** with competing products?



PRICE

- › What is the **usual price point** for this type of product?
- › How **much** is the customer willing to pay based on their perception of the product's value?
- › How might **minor tweaks** to the price affect sales volume and profit?

4Cs—consumer-oriented

Commodity, cost, communication, and convenience emphasize that customers are influencing the ingredients in the marketing mix.



COMMODITY

- › Has the **product** been designed, developed, and possibly even modified to meet and exceed customer expectations?
- › How and **why** will the design, size, features, color, and packaging appeal to a specific niche market?

COST

- › What will **attract** the customer? Premium quality? Low cost?
- › Do **customers make** buying decisions for this kind of product based on quality or on budget?
- › Will **target customers** think it represents good value?